BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

28 October 2026
Estimate Change


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US Communications Infrastructure

Equinix, Inc.

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

EQIX **1,270.00 USD**

Equinix (EQIX) 3Q26: Churn down for what - time to push pricing?

EQIX gave us the positive quarter we expected. Results at the top of the range, a third straight raise, and pricing with a number, as new deals were up 12% YoY (kW basis). Management also floated deliberately churning out underpriced, low-interconnection customers to re-price the base. We said we'd happily make that trade - here's hoping it's on the way in 2027.

Pricing, without the pain (for now): Renewals are showing "healthy increases in negotiated pricing," and MRR per cabinet rose 5.7% YoY, partly from density (customers left at 5 kW per cabinet and came in at 7 kW). Churn was 1.7% vs a 2–2.5% guide. If it rises in 2027, we'll read it as re-pricing. There may be a 30-60 day turnaround period, but we're not concerned about demand for that capacity.

Interconnection: We keep talking about it, and we're still waiting, but the building blocks are there. Fabric grew 24%, and Fabric One and Inference Exchange launch early next year with new pricing and packaging - the first move towards charging for value rather than volume. It's a technical challenge that will take time, but we're confident about the outcome.

The presales came back: Missing from the deck but back on the call. More than 20% of the record Q4 delivery and 15% of 2027 retail capacity are pre-sold; sold-but-not-installed backlog is at a record. Record bookings of $533M are the headline.

Same cabinets, new calendar, deeper bench: Capacity will beat the plan by about 40%, with the new capacity landing in 2029 - sensible given build times. Behind it sits 3 GW of developable capacity, about 80% in the top 25 metros and largely permitted, plus atNorth's 800 MW. This definition is important - EQIX likely has even more capacity earlier in the pipeline that they aren't ready to announce because it hasn't yet hit their milestones. The 3.8GW is a high-credibility capacity number.

Funding: Leverage hit 4.1x and new debt costs 5%+, vs a 3.2% blended rate. Management says it can double the portfolio with only a modest increase in leverage (aims to stay under 6x). The balance sheet is strong, but pricing has to cover a heavier interest bill in 2027.

Close Date	28 Oct 2026
EQIX Close Price (USD)	1,007.66
Price Target (USD)	1,270.00
Upside/(Downside)	26%
52-Week Range	1,128.68/720.62
SPX	7,743.98
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	2.0%
Market Cap (USD) (M)	99,747
EV (USD) (M)	120,895

Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	31.5	(0.3)	(6.4)	23.5
SPX (%)	13.1	0.8	8.5	12.4
Relative (%)	18.4	(1.1)	(14.9)	11.1

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Investment Implications

EQIX remains our top pick—we remain OP at $1,270. We value EQIX on a Price to AFFOPS multiple. Our price target is based on ~24x (prev 25x) NTM+1 AFFOPS of $52.88.

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
EQIX (USD)	14.96	**18.38**	**20.12**
OLD	--	17.12	20.13

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
EBITDA (M)	3,914	4,656	5,583	--

Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
Adjusted P/E (x)	67.4	54.8	50.1
EV/EBITDA (x)	30.9	26.0	21.7

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our Global Research Disclosure Website.

First Published: 29 Oct 2026 01:33 UTC Completion Date: 29 Oct 2026 01:33 UTC

DETAILS

WHAT WE LEARNED

Equinix delivered a strong third quarter, marked by record bookings and backlog, sustained double-digit recurring revenue growth, and increasingly meaningful pricing power, raising full-year 2026 revenue, adjusted EBITDA, and AFFO guidance for the third consecutive quarter. Management emphasized broad-based and durable demand across traditional and AI workloads, with new-deal pricing up 12% YoY, total sales activity growth of 38%, and capacity delivery running nearly 40% ahead of the company's original 2026 retail expansion plan. Despite industry concerns around power availability, community opposition, and capital markets volatility, management expressed confidence in its long-term outlook, framing the opportunity as one of execution rather than demand.

Record bookings and sustained double-digit MRR growth underscored continued momentum in the retail colocation and interconnection business. 3Q26 revenues totaled $2.571B, up 11% YoY as-reported and 12% on a normalized and constant-currency basis, while recurring revenues reached $2.442B. Monthly recurring revenue grew 11% YoY on a normalized and constant-currency basis, marking the fourth consecutive quarter of double-digit growth. In-quarter, Equinix delivered record annualized gross bookings of $533M, up 35% YoY, while total sales activity, including presales, increased 38%, its third consecutive quarter above 30% growth. Net cabinets billing increased by 5,700, and sold-but-not-installed backlog reached a record level. Management noted that 60% of its 4Q26 bookings target had already been closed, supporting continued momentum into year-end, and clarified that atNorth was excluded from these operating statistics and will be accounted for under the equity method rather than consolidated.

Pricing emerged as a more prominent growth lever, with management describing the company as being in the early stages of durable pricing strength as retail colocation supply remains constrained and much of industry CapEx targets wholesale capacity. New-deal pricing increased 12% YoY, providing a higher market benchmark against which to reprice the installed base as contracts renew. Management highlighted shorter contract durations relative to wholesale as an advantage in capturing mark-to-market opportunities, alongside incremental upside from higher power densities, upselling, and interconnection pricing and packaging. Churn was 1.7%, reflecting renewal execution, timing, and fewer alternatives for customers in a supply-constrained market. While these conditions are not expected to change in the near to medium term, management retained its 2%-2.5% churn assumption for the remainder of 2026 and noted that selective, intentional churn could help replace lower-priced, less interconnected customers with higher-value deployments.

Total interconnection revenue increased 10% YoY on both an as-reported and normalized and constant-currency basis to $465M, with Fabric revenue up 24% YoY. Net interconnection additions totaled 6,900 in the quarter. Equinix introduced Fabric One, with AWS and Google Cloud as lead integration partners, to automate complex networking configurations and reduce deployment times from weeks to minutes. Management positioned the offering as an enabler of enterprise inference and agentic AI strategies, with beta activity beginning in 4Q26 ahead of general availability in early 2027. Pricing, packaging, and any implications for the long-term outlook will be discussed following the beta process and commercial launch.

AI-related demand continued to translate into higher-density deployments and a broader ecosystem opportunity. Liquid cooling bookings increased more than tenfold YoY, while incoming customers averaged 7kW per cabinet versus 5kW for customers churning out. Equinix introduced Inference Exchange with NVIDIA and Together AI, providing enterprises access to more than 200 open models, and opened a global network of innovation centers for testing liquid-cooled AI infrastructure. Management also highlighted growing engagement with neoclouds as they expand from model training toward enterprise inference, adding 31 neocloud network nodes in the quarter to reach approximately 150 across the platform. Importantly, neoclouds collectively represent less than 2% of MRR, with management emphasizing strict credit protections and a measured approach to supporting the segment's growth.

Adjusted EBITDA reached $1.321B, up 15% YoY as-reported and 14% on a normalized and constant-currency basis, with a 51.4% margin, up approximately 180bps YoY on a normalized and constant-currency basis, driven by revenue growth, cost discipline, and operating leverage. AFFO totaled $1.156B, up 20% YoY as-reported, while AFFO per share increased 18% to $11.64. Results included a nonrecurring fee associated with the atNorth joint venture; excluding this benefit, AFFO and AFFO per share grew 14% and 12%, respectively, on a normalized and constant-currency basis. Management reiterated its path to adjusted EBITDA margins above 53% by 2029, supported by pricing, renewals and upselling, SG&A standardization and automation, and construction cost discipline. The expected sequential decline to a 49%-50% margin in 4Q26 reflects seasonal spending, with margins still expected to expand approximately 140bps YoY.

Capacity expansion continued ahead of plan under the Build Bolder strategy. Equinix ended the quarter with 48 projects underway across 32 markets and expects to deliver more than 13,000 cabinets in 4Q26, its largest quarterly delivery on record, with more than 20% already pre-sold. Approximately 15% of retail capacity scheduled for delivery in 2027 has also been pre-sold. The company highlighted 3GW of developable capacity, including projects in progress, with approximately 80% in its top 25 metros and land, power, and permitting largely secured. Separately, the completed atNorth investment alongside CPP Investments brings an 800MW active development pipeline over the next five years and an additional 1GW of future expansion opportunity. Management acknowledged some project-level delays, including a Dubai project deferred due to regional macro conditions, but emphasized its ability to offset individual delays across a diversified pipeline of generally smaller retail developments.

Capital deployment remained elevated, with approximately $1.6B of quarterly CapEx and roughly 90% directed toward capacity expansion. The company's 193 stabilized assets were collectively 83% utilized and generated a 27% cash-on-cash yield, with stabilized interconnection revenue growing 10% YoY versus 7% for colocation revenue. Net leverage stood at 4.1x, with $9.1B of available liquidity and an approximately 3.2% blended in-place borrowing rate, primarily fixed, with an average maturity exceeding six years. Management reiterated that its long-term expansion plan can be funded with only a modest leverage increase while preserving investment-grade credit ratings, with organic growth remaining the priority and any opportunistic acquisitions more likely oriented toward retail than xScale.

Equinix raised full-year 2026 guidance for the third consecutive quarter:

- **Revenue**: Raised by $100M at the midpoint to $10.325-$10.365B, representing approximately 12% growth on both an as-reported and normalized and constant-currency basis. The increase includes $84M of underlying improvement and $16M of favorable FX.
- **MRR growth**: Raised to 10%-11% on a normalized and constant-currency basis, with 4Q26 also expected to deliver 10%-11% growth.
- **Adjusted EBITDA**: Raised by $70M at the midpoint to $5.290-$5.330B, reflecting an approximately 51% margin and approximately 200bps of YoY expansion. The increase includes $59M of underlying improvement and $11M of favorable FX.
- **AFFO**: Raised by $90M at the midpoint to $4.340-$4.380B, including $52M of underlying improvement, a $31M contribution from the atNorth joint venture, and $7M of favorable FX. **AFFO per share** guidance increased by $0.92 at the midpoint to $43.71-$44.11, representing 14%-15% growth as-reported and 11%-12% on a normalized and constant-currency basis.
- **CapEx**: Unchanged at $5.0-$6.0B, excluding real estate acquisitions and xScale.
- **Churn**: Management retained its typical 2%-2.5% assumption for the remainder of 2026 despite 1.7% churn in 3Q26, with potential intentional churn supporting installed-base repricing and customer mix optimization.

OUR RECENT WORK ON EQUINIX

- US Industrials & Tech: The Data Center Project Pipeline - Capacity, Construction & Cancellations (Sept '26)
- The Bernstein Data Center Atlas: An interactive, in-depth, virtual data center walk through
- U.S. Data Center Capacity: Your seat is skewing your numbers. Five ways to forecast DC capacity (and our definitive view)
- Data Center Interconnection: A literal network effect
- Data Centers: What a top-tier data center market looks like—including the DLR and EQIX footprints

EXHIBIT 1: **EQIX 3Q26 Variance Table**

EQIX 3Q26 Variance Table							
	Actual 3Q26	Estimate 3Q26	Consensus 3Q26	Forecast Variance	Actual 3Q25	*Annual Growth* Actual	*Annual Growth* Forecast
Recurring Revenue	**2,442**	**2,430**	**2,440**	**0.1%**	**2,215**	**10.2%**	**10.2%**
Colocation	1,826	1,786	1,818	0.4%	1,637	11.5%	11.1%
Interconnection	465	467	465	-0.1%	422	10.2%	10.3%
Managed Infrastructure	108	135	116	-7.0%	118	-8.5%	-1.6%
Other	43	41	40	6.4%	38	13.2%	6.3%
Non-Recurring Revenue	129	128	127	1.5%	101	27.7%	25.9%
Total Revenue	**$2,571**	**$2,558**	**$2,567**	**0.1%**	**$2,316**	**11.0%**	**10.8%**
Adj. EBITDA	**$1,321**	**$1,313**	**$1,305**	**1.2%**	**$1,148**	**15.1%**	**13.7%**
Adj. EBITDA Margin	51.4%	51.3%	50.8%	55bps	49.6%	181bps	127bps
Net Income	**$489**	**$392**	**$402**	**21.6%**	**$374**	**30.7%**	**7.5%**
Adj. Funds from Operations	1,156	1,058	1,049	10.2%	965	19.8%	8.8%
AFFO Per Share	**$11.70**	**$10.73**	**$10.55**	**11.0%**	**$9.85**	**18.8%**	**7.1%**
EPS Diluted	$4.93	$3.96	$4.02	22.4%	$3.81	29.3%	5.6%
Adj. Diluted EPS	**$5.25**	**$3.96**	**$4.07**	**29.0%**	**$3.92**	**33.8%**	**3.8%**
Recurring CapEx	68	90	74	-7.5%	64	6.3%	14.9%
Non-Recurring CapEx	1,490	1,052	1,322	12.7%	1,072	39.0%	23.3%

Source: Company Disclosures, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 2: **EQIX FY26 Guidance**

FY26 Guidance				
	Midpoint *Given 3Q26*	**Midpoint** *Given 2Q26*	**Consensus** *FY 2026*	**Estimate** *FY 2026*
Revenue	10,345	10,245	10,275	10,338
Adj. EBITDA	**$5,310**	**$5,240**	**$5,276**	**$5,270**
Adj. EBITDA Margin	*51.3%*	*51.1%*	*51.3%*	*51.0%*
Recurring CapEx	300	300	275	307
Non-Recurring CapEx	5,200	5,200	4,537	5,663
AFFO	4,360	4,270	4,291	4,378
AFFO per share	**$43.91**	**$42.99**	**$43.25**	**$44.45**

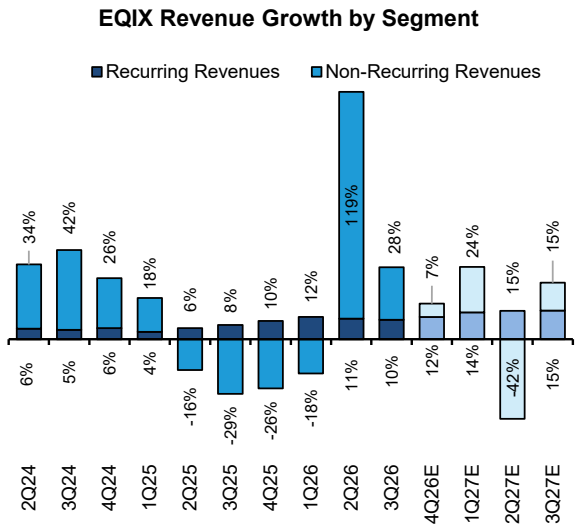
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 3: **EQIX Long Term Guidance**

Long Term 2027-2029 Guidance		
	Updated Outlook 2Q26	***Midpoint***
Total Revenue Growth (Annual Range)	10% - 13%	12%
Adjusted EBITDA Margin (in 2029)	**53%+**	**53%+**
Total Capital Expenditures (Annual Range)	$5 - $7B	$6.0B
AFFO per Share Growth (Annual Range)	**9% - 12%**	**11%**
Dividend per Share Growth (Annual Range)	**Approximately AFFO per Share Growth**	**11%**
Net Leverage Ratio (In 2029)	**In-line with Current Investment Grade Ratings**	

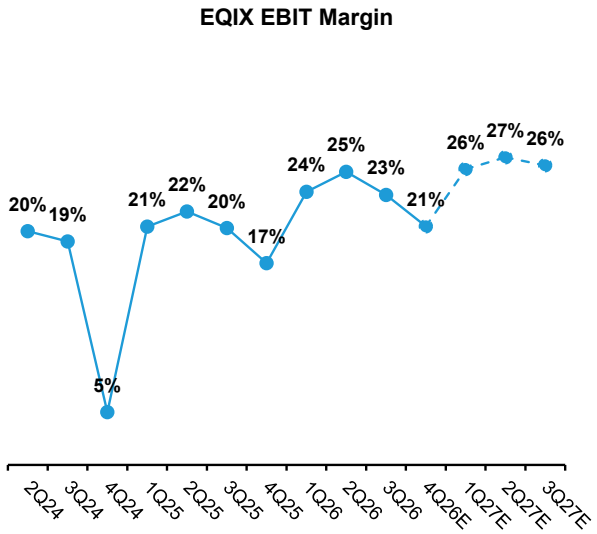
CAPEX Excludes M&A activity, real estate acquisitions and xScale
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 4: **EQIX Revenue YoY Growth by Segment (%)**



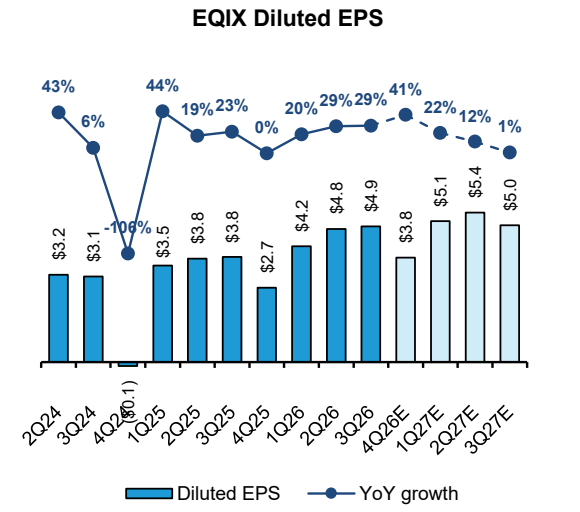
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 5: **EQIX EBIT Margin**



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 6: **EQIX Diluted EPS ($, %)**



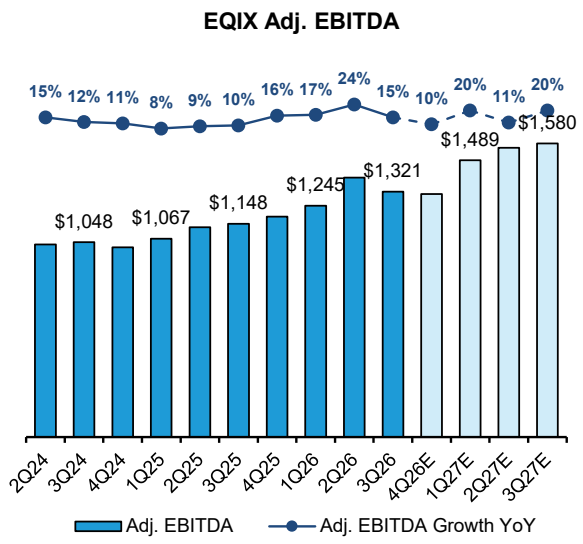
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 7: **EQIX AFFO YoY Growth ($M, %)**



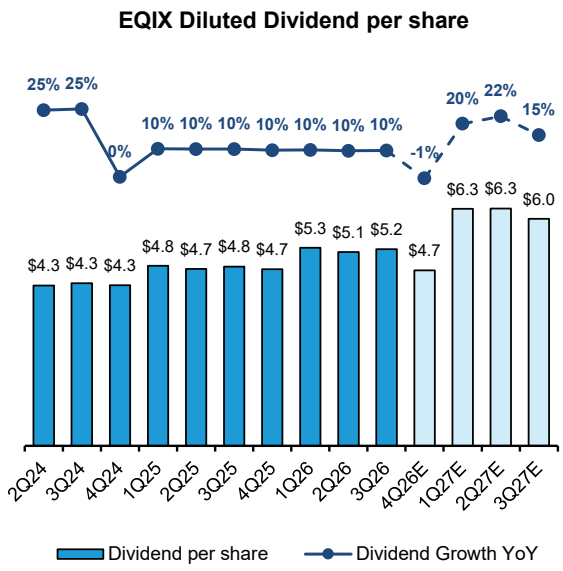
Source: Company Filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 8: **EQIX Adj. EBITDA YoY Growth ($M, %)**



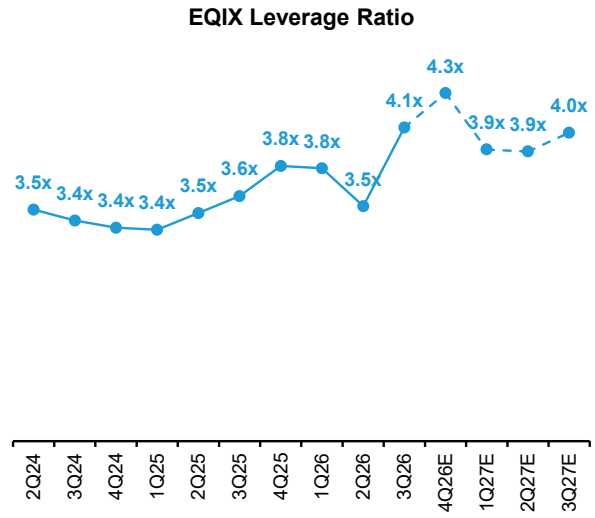
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 9: **EQIX Diluted Dividend per Share ($, %)**



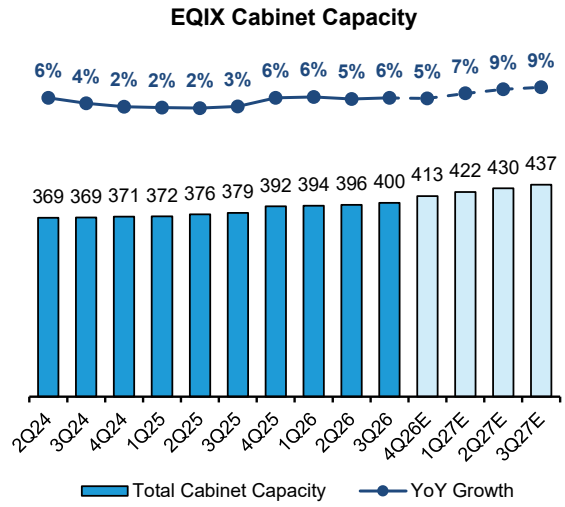
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 10: **EQIX Leverage Ratio**



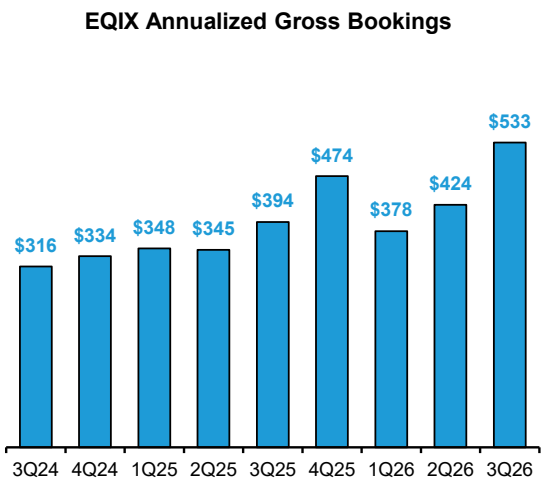
Calculates as Net debt including fin leases and Q Annualized Adj. EBITDA
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 11: **EQIX Cabinet Capacity (k, %)**



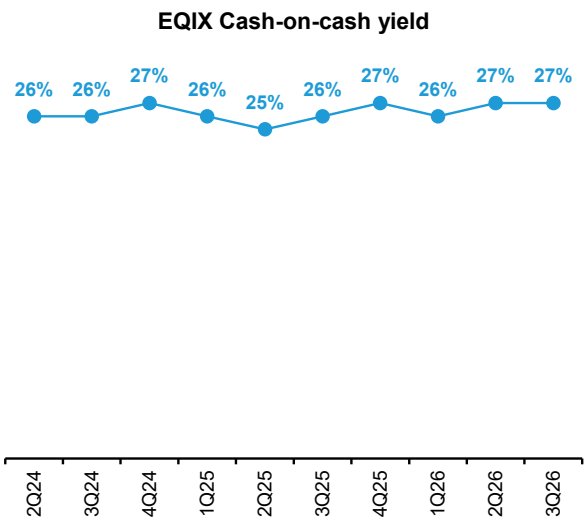
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 12: **EQIX Annualized Gross Bookings ($M)**



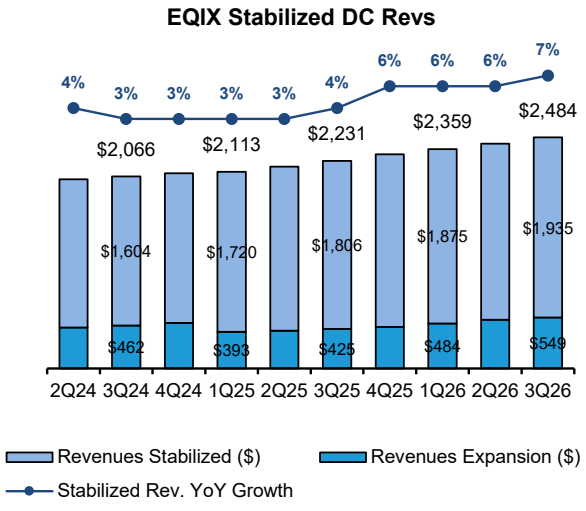
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 13: **EQIX Cash-on-cash yield**



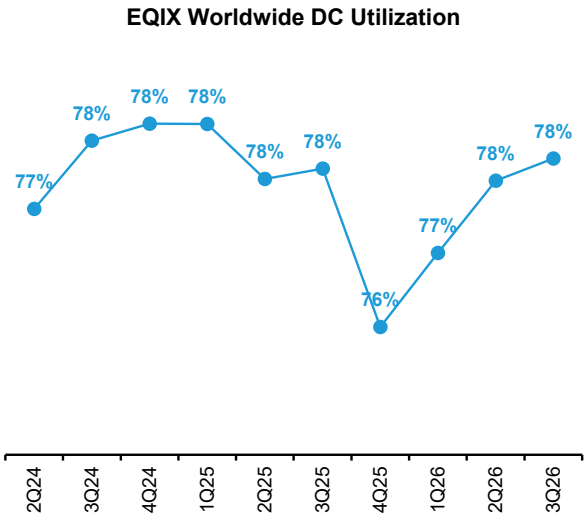
Cash Generated on Gross PP&E investment calculated as: Cash gross profit for the trailing four quarters on a constant currency basis divided by gross PP&E
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 14: **EQIX Stabilized DC Revs ($M, %)**



YoY Growth calculated on a constant currency basis
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 15: **EQIX Stabilized DC Utilization Rate (%)**



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 16: **EQIX Income Statement Overview**

All values in millions, except per share data

	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E	3Q27E	FY 2025	FY 2026	FY 2027	FY 2028	FY 2029
Recurring Revenues	2,294	2,331	2,377	2,442	2,563	2,661	2,733	2,811	8,739	9,713	11,093	12,513	14,142
Non-Recurring Revenues	126	113	248	129	135	140	144	148	478	625	584	659	745
Total Revenues	2,420	2,444	2,625	2,571	2,698	2,801	2,877	2,959	9,217	10,338	11,677	13,172	14,887
Cost of revenues	1,198	1,186	1,230	1,257	1,358	1,336	1,361	1,421	4,508	5,031	5,633	6,300	7,075
Gross profit	1,222	1,258	1,395	1,314	1,340	1,465	1,515	1,538	4,709	5,307	6,043	6,872	7,811
Total operating expenses	800	681	730	714	795	777	778	800	2,861	2,920	3,166	3,503	3,931
Income from operations	422	577	665	600	544	688	737	738	1,848	2,386	2,877	3,369	3,880
Income before income taxes	312	471	523	537	416	549	584	532	1,508	1,947	2,157	2,352	2,643
Income tax expense	(48)	(56)	(46)	(48)	(52)	(69)	(73)	(66)	(160)	(202)	(270)	(294)	(330)
xScale & atNorth contribution to Net income	-	-	-	-	12	27	27	27	-	12	110	214	366
Net income	264	415	477	489	376	507	538	493	1,348	1,757	1,997	2,273	2,678
Net (income) / loss attributable to non-controlling interests	1	-	2	-	-	-	-	-	2	2	-	-	-
Net income attributable to common stockholders	265	415	479	489	376	507	538	493	1,350	1,759	1,997	2,273	2,678
(+) Adjustments	85	(4)	29	32	-	-	-	-	118	57	-	-	-
Adjusted Net Income	350	411	508	521	376	507	538	493	1,468	1,816	1,997	2,273	2,678
Earnings per share (EPS)													
EPS (basic)	2.70	4.22	4.86	4.95	3.81	5.14	5.45	4.99	13.79	17.86	20.22	23.00	27.11
EPS (diluted)	2.69	4.20	4.83	4.93	3.79	5.11	5.42	4.96	13.76	17.80	20.12	22.89	26.98
Adjusted EPS (diluted)	3.56	4.16	5.12	5.25	3.79	5.11	5.42	4.96	14.96	18.38	20.12	22.89	26.98
Adjusted FFO (AFFO) per share (basic)	8.93	10.82	11.84	11.70	10.01	12.64	12.66	12.11	38.42	44.45	48.45	55.05	61.97

Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			28 Oct 2026		TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.							
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
EQIX (Equinix)	O	USD	1,007.66	1,270.00	11.1%	USD	14.96	**18.38**	**20.12**	67.4	54.8	50.1
OLD								17.12	20.13			
SPX			7,743.98									

ESTIMATE CHANGE IN BOLD

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the “Firm” in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK（サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社）and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

Bernstein is part of a joint venture between Société Générale (SG) and AllianceBernstein, L.P. (AB). Unless specifically noted otherwise, for purposes of these disclosures, references to Bernstein’s “affiliates” relate to both SG and AB and their respective affiliates.

VALUATION METHODOLOGY

Equinix, Inc.

We value EQIX on a forward Price-to-Adjusted Funds From Operations (AFFO) multiple. Our $1,270 price target is based on ~24x NTM+1 AFFO per share of $52.88.

RISKS

Equinix, Inc.

The main downside risks to our price target/Outperform rating on EQIX are 1) Slowdown in enterprise demand for data center capacity, 2) Increased competition in the interconnection space, and 3) Continuing decline in market share of data center supply may elevate pricing pressures

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS

Bernstein brand

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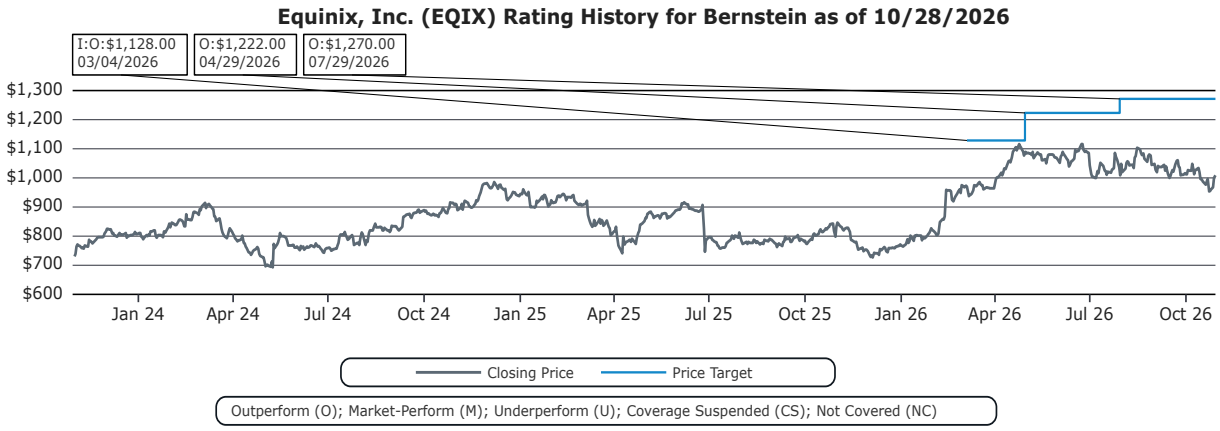
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